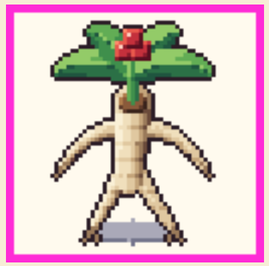
Gnome Venture

The art journey

From the first placeholders to the Hearth Pop look, October to November 2026









Four looks in one project

What each stage was, as shipped in the game

Stage 1: SVG placeholders

the first builds, before 2.2.0

1,434 emoji-and-shape SVGs in assets/img/ph, drawn by script so every item and villager had something to show.

Stage 2: first pixel art

2.2.0, 30 Oct 2026

Placeholders replaced by 64x64 item PNGs, 80x100 portraits, 201 creature miniatures, 180 scene pictures.

Stage 3: scene overhaul

2.2 to 2.5.4x, Oct to Nov

Stitched-toy scenes: stage backdrops, trek scenes, banners, interiors, world and region maps, underground world.

Stage 4: Hearth Pop v3

2.5.48 to 2.5.64, Nov 2026

Warm hero-scale look: 1px ink rim, upper-left light, 3 to 5 tone ramps. Items, gather art, 2.5D villager sprites, gate-view scenes, seed packets, redrawn weak pictures.

Items: placeholder, first pixel art, now

Left to right in each group: SVG placeholder (where kept), 2.2.0 pixel art, 2.5.64





acai





ginseng





tomato





pear




finger-lime




fox-fang




frog-skin




frost-fur




gravel-path




garden-gate-cross



sun-dried-tomatoes




stuffed-peppers-goat

Villager portraits

2.2.0 portraits on the left of each pair; now on the right (all villagers are creatures, never humans)




npc-bram




npc-auntie-mossbead




npc-ginger-thornwhistle




npc-zinnia-fuzzbottom




npc-bramble-mossfoot




npc-grandmother-hoshi




npc-fern-sunpatch




npc-juniper-kettleby

Scenes and maps

Then (2.2.0, left) and now (2.5.64, right)




stage-grassland




stage-forest




map-world




map-NA






Creature miniatures

Same 201 files, then and now



gnome-body



leafcutter-column



crew-burdock



spadefoot-toad



npc-ginger-thornwhistle



npc-moss-sunpatch



drumming-cricket



cloud-leopard



cave-glowworm



badger



npc-gloam



npc-sakuya-brushwick

A hedgehog lesson

First draft (messy-haired kid), failed redo (mice and kids), final (real hedgehogs)



first



failed redo



final

Seeds became seed packets

The 16px seeds all read as blobs, so each seed is now a paper packet with a window, big seeds and a sprout


acai


acanthus


ackee


adzuki


african-tulip-tree

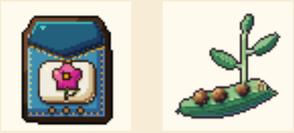

african-violet


agapanthus


allamanda


almond-peach


almond


alstroemeria


amaranth


apple


apricot

This round: scene fixes and kind cards

Camp, ferry, wild trail, Snowcrown, turtle, kava, banner, trek-me, vig-pick, kind cards

craft



collect



tend



contest



vig-pick



trek-me x6



banner-desert



Scene fixes

Camp, ferry, wild trail, Snowcrown Peak, kava circle, turtle nesting beach



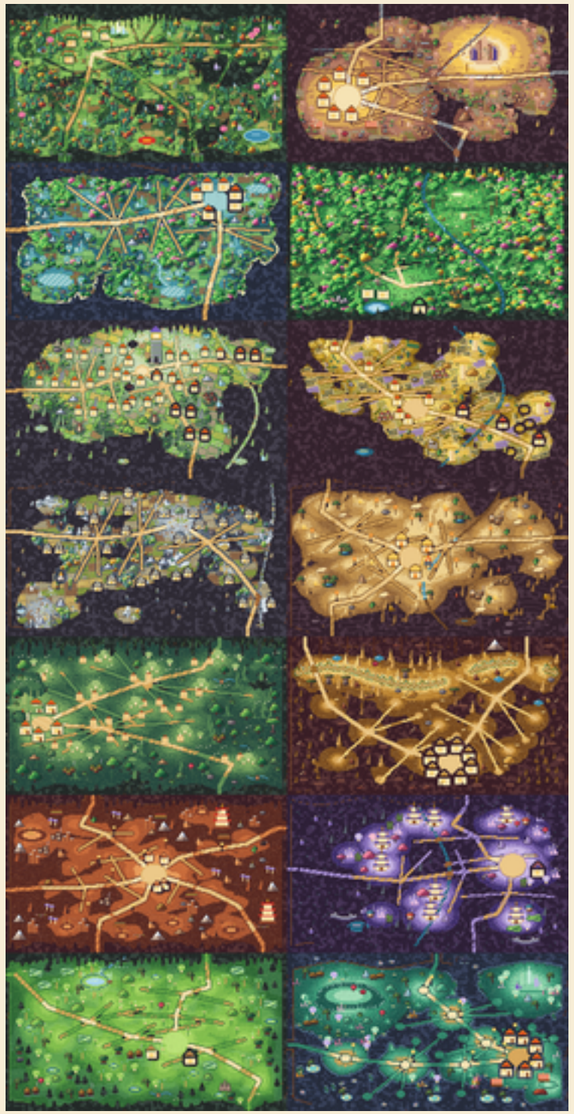
World map

Underground world, richness pass



The 14 region maps

Richness pass, same layout, pins stay clear



Rest stop desert looks

11 stop types, one desert adobe look each



Hero-scale places

Village, haven, delve, lair and Maplewold with its new Beaver Pond



By the numbers

Pictures in the game at 2.2.0 (30 Oct) versus 2.5.64

Group	2.2.0	2.5.64
Item and creature pictures (ph, png)	1501	1669
SVG placeholders kept in ph	1434	1434
Scene pictures	171	246
Creature miniatures	201	201
2.5D villager sprites	0	81
Folk pictures	11	11

Built with Aseprite 1.3.18 Lua scripts, one parametric generator per family, and agents drawing in parallel.